GRADUATE ADMISSIONS HACK

How to Apply to US Universities For Exactly $0 in Fees

Stop paying $100 per application. How to save $1,500+ applying to Master's & PhD programs.

5-Slide Cheat Sheet • Swipe to Learn 👉

01 Strategy 1: Virtual Open Houses & Webinars

Top universities issue automated $75–$125 fee waiver coupon codes to all webinar attendees:

Purdue University & Stevens Tech

Attend official Graduate Engineering virtual sessions to receive automated waiver promo codes in your inbox.

Case Western Reserve & Rochester

Waives fees automatically upon attending virtual recruitment fairs.

Timing Tip

Attend sessions between August and November before December 1 priority deadlines.

02 Strategy 2: Direct Department Head Email Requests

Graduate coordinators have discretionary budgets to waive application fees for strong international candidates:

Identify Graduate Program Director (GPD)

Locate email on the department faculty directory.

Highlight Research Alignment

Attach 1–page CV + 3–sentence summary of your GPA and target professors' research lab.

Direct Ask

Politely request a departmental fee waiver code to submit your formal application.

03 Strategy 3: Early Priority Application Windows

Several institutions offer 100% free applications during specific early bird windows:

University of Dayton & Michigan Tech

Free application windows during early submission cycle.

GEM & SACNAS Consortiums

Full application fee waivers across 50+ partner research institutions.

Gre Fee Match Programs

Submit unofficial transcripts to avoid $30 score reporting fees until acceptance.

FREE DOWNLOAD

Get 35+ University Waiver Codes & Email Templates

Access the verified 2026 fee waiver directory + copy-paste email scripts on our platform.

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